

Sightline (grade 6 edition) — play-through review

Theme `sightline_ms` · middle-school psychology and measurement, grade 6 · 10 days, 30 stops · reviewed 2026-08-21
by reading `books/sightline-ms.yml` in full, working every board, and comparing against the parent `sightline`.

Verdict

The best junior edition in the repo, on every number I can measure. `per-day` is `[3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3]`. **Nine** — Review **variants**, so six of ten days carry a callback and a child meets each idea twice. **Zero rows in every debt file. 5 of 5 syllabus relations computed, 15 of 15 concepts touched, and zero select-only concepts** — the only campaign in the entire catalogue, senior or junior, with all three of those at once. **Zero numeral damage.** `questionLoad` reports 6 of 39 demanding stops (15%), and every one of the six is a board-size note rather than a reading problem. Fourteen distinct formats across thirty stops, including a CLOUD, a TRACE, a STRESS and an ATTEST at grade 6.

And the content is not softened. The six boards are the parent's arithmetic at a sixth grader's pace — the one-in-six pick rate, what an eye can make out at twenty-two metres, the illuminance on the doorway, the functional size of the array from mock witnesses, a centimetre of face at the surveyed distance, and what nineteen hours does to a score. The parent's whole method survives: measure the distance instead of arguing about it, date every claim in the file, and show the photographs to people who were never there rather than asking a witness to be sure one more time.

The ending is the bravest in the junior set. It names two people the report damaged — Alma Cardoza, who read in a newspaper that the identification she gave in good faith had been taken apart, and Karen Loomis, named in a judgment for running a line-up the way the rules told her to — and it says the court "said plainly that they were not finding him innocent." At grade 6.

Answerable: 30/30. **Sense:** Excellent, and cumulative in the same way the parent is. **Level:** Right, and written against the gate from the first stop rather than swept afterwards. **Fun:** High in a register nothing else in the junior set uses — forensic rather than dramatic.

Findings

ID	Sev	Where	Issue	Proposed fix
SG-01	WORTH	Authored <code>background</code> , 14 of 39 stops missing	Thirty-nine guides, twenty-five backgrounds. Every stop has a <code>guide</code> , so the card is complete — but this is the campaign whose <i>mechanisms</i> most reward a paragraph behind the door, because the psychology is counter-intuitive at every stop: why a functional array size of one and a half is possible when there are six photographs, why distress at interview says nothing about the identification, why a fitted curve is right and its extrapolation is not.	Add background to the fourteen, one paragraph each, answering "why is the obvious reading wrong here". The parent's equivalentes are good and most can be shortened rather than rewritten.

SG- 02	TASTE	One format change worth checking	The parent's "The signature and the thing it stands for" is an ATTEST; here it is a PROTOCOL. That is a legitimate conversion — an ATTEST's four-claim board is at the junior list limit — and <code>questionLoad</code> is satisfied. Recording it because the ATTEST's subject (<i>the record is not the condition</i>) is one of the two ideas this campaign exists to teach, and a PROTOCOL asks a different kind of question.	Check the PROTOCOL still asks <i>whether the record can stand behind the claim</i> rather than <i>which record goes with which claim</i> . If it does, nothing to do.
SG- 03	TASTE	The opening card	Names Ines Baptiste and Ren Okada, both with jobs and both with positions — " <i>wants it filed this month</i> " against " <i>the one account nobody has touched yet is what a rushed report would use up</i> ". Model, and better than eleven senior campaigns.	Nothing.

That is the whole list. `sightline_ms` is the campaign I would hand somebody as the specification for a **junior edition**, and the reason is in `MIDDLE_SCHOOL_EDITIONS.md` §9: it was written against `questionLoad` from the first stop instead of being derived and then swept, and the result is a different and better edition for less work.

What the derivation did well, and what the set should copy

- **Written to the gate.** Zero debt rows, 100% of equations computed, no select-only concepts, no numeral damage. None of that is luck.
- **Nine review variants.** Six of ten days carry a callback. Thirty-seven campaigns have none.
- **It kept the hard ideas and shortened the sentences**, which is the whole distinction `MIDDLE_SCHOOL_EDITIONS.md` insists on and that nine of the first-pass editions got wrong.
- **It kept the cost.** A grade-6 game that names the people its own protagonist's report hurt is doing something almost nothing else here attempts.

Opening and closing

Opening: 108 words, both sides named with positions, and the clock is a man's life — "if the board says no, nobody looks at this again until 2033."

Closing: three paragraphs, all three doing work. Keep every word.

Warm-ups

Authored for this edition. No findings.